

# Mark: The Suffering Servant King

*The fastest Gospel asks the slowest question about who Jesus really is.*

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**Text.** Mark 1 to 16

**Good for.** A whole church, including people who think they already know the story

**The arc.** Mark drives toward a single confession and refuses to let you make it cheaply. The first half asks who this is, the second half answers that the King is the one who dies, and the cross is not the interruption of the kingdom but its arrival.

## 1. The Beginning of the Gospel

*Mark 1:1-20*

**Big idea.** The King arrives announced by a wilderness voice and calls ordinary men to drop their nets and follow.

**Aim.** To make the hearer feel the urgency of a kingdom that interrupts the day you were having.

*Notes*

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## 2. Authority Over Everything

*Mark 1:21 to 2:12*

**Big idea.** Jesus commands demons, disease, and sin itself, claiming an authority that belongs to God alone.

**Aim.** To move the hearer from admiring Jesus to reckoning with what He is claiming about Himself.

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### 3. New Cloth, Old Garments

*Mark 2:13 to 3:6*

**Big idea.** The kingdom does not patch the old religious system but replaces it, and the keepers of the old will plot to kill the one who brings it.

**Aim.** To expose the religion in us that would rather guard a rule than receive a Savior.

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### 4. Ears to Hear

*Mark 4:1-34*

**Big idea.** The kingdom comes hidden as seed, and the heart that receives the word is the only soil that bears fruit.

**Aim.** To press the hearer to ask what kind of ground their own life has become.

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## 5. Power and Fear on the Water

*Mark 4:35 to 5:43*

**Big idea.** The one who stills the storm, frees the demoniac, and raises the dead is met first with terror, because real power is more frightening than the chaos it ends.

**Aim.** To let the hearer feel that meeting Jesus is not safe before it is good.

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## 6. Bread in the Wilderness

*Mark 6:30-52*

**Big idea.** Jesus feeds the crowd and walks on the sea, and still the disciples do not understand, because their hearts are hard.

**Aim.** To name how near we can stand to the work of God and still miss who is doing it.

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## 7. You Are the Christ

*Mark 8:22-38*

**Big idea.** At the hinge of the Gospel Peter sees who Jesus is, and immediately misreads what that means, because the Christ has come to die.

**Aim.** To force the hearer to hold the confession and the cross together rather than choosing one.

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## 8. The Last Will Be First

*Mark 9:30 to 10:45*

**Big idea.** On the road to Jerusalem the disciples argue about greatness while the King defines it as the Son of Man giving His life as a ransom for many.

**Aim.** To overturn the hearer's instinct that following Jesus is a path upward.

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## 9. The King Enters and Indicts

*Mark 11:1 to 12:12*

**Big idea.** Jesus enters Jerusalem, judges the temple, and tells the parable that names His own death at the hands of those who should have welcomed Him.

**Aim.** To let the hearer stand among the crowd and feel which side of the gate they are on.

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## 10. Crucified, and the Veil Torn

*Mark 15:1-39*

**Big idea.** The King reigns from a cross, and the first human being to confess Him truly is the Roman soldier who watched Him die.

**Aim.** To bring the hearer to the centurion's confession and ask whether it is theirs.

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## 11. He Is Not Here

*Mark 16:1-8*

**Big idea.** The tomb is empty, the women are afraid, and the Gospel ends mid-breath because the rest of the story is the one telling it.

**Aim.** To leave the hearer standing where Mark leaves them, having to decide what they will do with an empty grave.

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### HOW TO USE THIS SERIES

These are starting points, not scripts. Each series gives you the arc, the divisions, and a working aim for every sermon, but the breakdown here is scaffolding you will take down once the text has done its own work in you. Read the whole book before you preach the first week of it. Let the passage divisions teach you where the seams actually are.

The text sets the agenda. Not the felt needs you arrived with, not the outline that looks clean on a slide, not the application you already know you want to land. Sit under the passage long enough for it to surprise you, and then preach what it says rather than what you planned. A big idea you did not have to fight for is usually one the text did not give you.